reaffirming support for the “two-track” policy that included deployment of the new missiles as well as continued negotiations aimed at eliminating intermediate-range weapons from Europe.

Everything was settled, or so it seemed. The next morning, however, François Mitterrand and Pierre Trudeau declared that they couldn’t support the statement, and in effect called those of us who favored installing the new missiles warmongers. Obviously, they had gotten together the night before and decided to renege on the previous day’s agreement.

Our discussion became very hot, with the two of them entrenched on one side of the argument and the rest of us on the other. I was angry at their turnabout and spoke for twenty minutes straight defending our position.

Because of the disagreement, we were an hour late for lunch. As we left the meeting for the building where lunch was to be served, our group walked together and they walked alone. Neither group spoke to the other throughout lunch. In our afternoon session, we asked our foreign ministers to work on a revised statement that would satisfy Mitterrand and Trudeau but not water down the heart of the communiqué; then we started working on a statement of economic policy endorsing liberalization of trade policies. Once again, from out of the blue, Mitterrand and Trudeau objected.

“I thought at one point Margaret Thatcher was going to order Pierre to go stand in a corner,” I recorded in my diary that night. “It was hard to remember [that] we had started the day with a prayer service in the tiny church. Maybe that’s what did it because we closed the day with both issues resolved, cordiality restored and no winners or losers.”

A year later, there was a similar dispute at the economic summit in London, with Mitterrand and Trudeau again